

Management Principles and Practice

Course: CS — Certified Secretaries

Level: Foundation Level (CS11)

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Syllabus version: Based on the standard KASNEB CS Foundation Level Management Principles and Practice syllabus topics (CS11) — the functions of management, organisational structures, motivation and leadership. Authored from general management knowledge and standard syllabus topic coverage, not copied from any existing notes provider or study guide. Cross-check terminology and emphasis against the current KASNEB syllabus and examiner's reports before the exam.

Original work notice. Every explanation, worked example, and question in this document was written from scratch for this paper. No text has been copied or paraphrased from any KASNEB past paper, textbook, or third-party notes/study guide. The scenarios and practice questions are original.

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1. What is management?

Management is the process of working with and through people and other resources to accomplish an organisation's goals efficiently (minimum necessary resources) and effectively (actually achieving the intended goal).

2. The functions of management

The classical functions of management: **planning** (setting objectives and deciding how to achieve them), **organising** (arranging resources and tasks to implement the plan), **staffing** (recruiting and developing people), **directing/leading** (guiding and motivating staff toward objectives), and **controlling** (monitoring performance against plans and correcting deviations). These functions are continuous and overlapping in practice, not a strict one-time sequence.

3. Levels of management

- **Top management** — sets overall organisational direction and strategy (e.g. board, chief executive).
 - **Middle management** — translates strategy into departmental plans, coordinating between top and lower management.
 - **Lower (first-line) management** — directly supervises operational staff carrying out day-to-day tasks.
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4. Organisational structures

- **Functional structure** — organised by specialised function (finance, marketing, operations); efficient for a single-focus organisation.
 - **Divisional structure** — organised around products, services, or geographic markets; suits diversified organisations.
 - **Matrix structure** — combines functional and divisional/project reporting lines; suits organisations needing flexibility across multiple projects, though it can create dual-reporting complexity.
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5. Motivation theories

- **Maslow's hierarchy of needs** — people are motivated by satisfying needs in order: physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualisation.

- **Herzberg's two-factor theory** — distinguishes **hygiene factors** (e.g. pay, working conditions — their absence causes dissatisfaction, but their presence doesn't necessarily motivate) from **motivators** (e.g. achievement, recognition, responsibility — genuinely drive motivation).
 - **McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y** — Theory X assumes employees are inherently unmotivated and need close supervision; Theory Y assumes employees are self-motivated and seek responsibility — shaping very different management styles.
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6. Leadership styles

- **Autocratic** — leader makes decisions unilaterally, with limited input from others.
- **Democratic (participative)** — leader involves team members in decision-making.
- **Laissez-faire** — leader gives significant autonomy, providing minimal direct oversight.

The most effective style generally depends on the situation — task urgency, team competence and experience, and the nature of the decision all influence which style works best in a given context.

7. Decision-making in management

A structured decision-making process: identify the problem → gather relevant information → identify possible alternatives → evaluate alternatives against relevant criteria → select and implement the best alternative → monitor and review the outcome. Good decision-making balances thorough analysis with the practical need to decide within a reasonable time frame — excessive analysis can itself become a costly delay.

8. Span of control and organisational design

Span of control is the number of subordinates a manager directly supervises. A **narrow span of control** allows closer supervision but requires more management layers (a "tall" structure); a **wide span of control** requires fewer management layers (a "flat" structure) but demands more delegation and subordinate capability, since a manager cannot supervise many people as closely.

9. Full worked question — span of control analysis

Scenario. A department has 60 staff members. Management is considering two structures: Structure A, with a span of control of 6 (each supervisor manages 6 staff), and Structure B, with a span of control of 12.

Required: (a) Compute the number of first-line supervisors required under each structure. (b) Explain one advantage and one disadvantage of Structure B compared to Structure A.

Solution:

(a) Structure A: $60 \div 6 = 10$ **supervisors**. Structure B: $60 \div 12 = 5$ **supervisors**.

(b) **Advantage of Structure B:** fewer supervisors are needed, reducing management overhead cost and creating a flatter, potentially faster-communicating structure.

Disadvantage of Structure B: each supervisor has less time available per subordinate, which can reduce the quality of direct supervision and support unless subordinates are highly capable and require less close oversight.

10. Practice examination — KASNEB-style paper (original, not a past paper)

Note on format. This section is laid out the way a KASNEB CS examination paper is laid out — a timed paper with five compulsory 20-mark questions — purely so you can practise under realistic exam conditions. Every question below is an original scenario written for this document. **It is not a reproduction of any actual KASNEB past examination paper.**

CS FOUNDATION LEVEL — MANAGEMENT PRINCIPLES AND PRACTICE (PRACTICE PAPER)

TIME ALLOWED: 3 HOURS

Instructions to candidates: Answer ALL FIVE questions. Each question carries 20 marks. Show all workings clearly.

QUESTION ONE

- (a) Define "management" and distinguish "efficiency" from "effectiveness." (8 marks)
 - (b) Outline the FIVE classical functions of management. (10 marks)
 - (c) Explain why these functions are described as continuous and overlapping. (2 marks)
- (Total: 20 marks)

QUESTION TWO

- (a) Distinguish between top, middle and lower (first-line) management. *(9 marks)*
 - (b) Distinguish between a functional and a divisional organisational structure. *(8 marks)*
 - (c) Outline ONE disadvantage of a matrix structure. *(3 marks)*
- (Total: 20 marks)*
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QUESTION THREE

- (a) Outline Maslow's hierarchy of needs. *(10 marks)*
 - (b) Distinguish between hygiene factors and motivators under Herzberg's two-factor theory. *(10 marks)*
- (Total: 20 marks)*
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QUESTION FOUR

- (a) Distinguish between autocratic, democratic and laissez-faire leadership styles. *(12 marks)*
 - (b) Explain why the most effective leadership style depends on the situation. *(8 marks)*
- (Total: 20 marks)*
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QUESTION FIVE

A department has 80 staff, and management is deciding between a span of control of 8 and a span of control of 16.

- (a) Compute the number of supervisors required under each option. *(6 marks)*
 - (b) Explain the relationship between span of control and the number of management layers (a "tall" versus "flat" structure). *(8 marks)*
 - (c) Outline the FIVE steps in a structured decision-making process. *(6 marks)*
- (Total: 20 marks)*
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11. Marking guide — model answers to the practice examination

QUESTION ONE

- (a) *(8 marks)* — Management is working with and through people/resources to accomplish organisational goals; efficiency = minimum necessary resources ("doing things right"); effectiveness = achieving the intended goal ("doing the right things").

(b) (10 marks — 2 marks each) — Planning, organising, staffing, directing/leading, controlling.

(c) (2 marks) — Managers perform these functions repeatedly and simultaneously in practice, rather than completing one fully before starting the next.

QUESTION TWO

(a) (9 marks — 3 marks each) — Top management: sets overall direction/strategy. Middle management: translates strategy into departmental plans. Lower management: directly supervises operational staff.

(b) (8 marks) — Functional: organised by specialised function, efficient for single-focus organisations. Divisional: organised by product/market/geography, suits diversified organisations.

(c) (3 marks) — Dual reporting lines can create confusion over authority and conflicting priorities for staff.

QUESTION THREE

(a) (10 marks — 2 marks each) — Physiological, safety, social, esteem, self-actualisation, in ascending order.

(b) (10 marks) — Hygiene factors (e.g. pay, conditions): absence causes dissatisfaction, presence doesn't necessarily motivate. Motivators (e.g. achievement, recognition): genuinely drive motivation when present.

QUESTION FOUR

(a) (12 marks — 4 marks each) — Autocratic: unilateral decisions, limited input. Democratic: involves team in decisions. Laissez-faire: significant autonomy, minimal oversight.

(b) (8 marks) — Effectiveness depends on factors like task urgency, team competence/experience, and decision nature — e.g. an urgent crisis may need autocratic speed, while an experienced team on a complex problem may benefit from a democratic approach.

QUESTION FIVE

(a) (6 marks) — Span of 8: $80 \div 8 = 10$ **supervisors**. Span of 16: $80 \div 16 = 5$ **supervisors**.

(b) (8 marks) — A narrow span of control requires more management layers (a "tall" structure) for closer supervision; a wide span requires fewer layers (a "flat" structure) but demands more delegation and subordinate capability.

(c) (6 marks) — Identify the problem, gather information, identify alternatives, evaluate alternatives, select/implement, monitor and review (any five of these, 1 mark each, or a condensed correct version).

12. Exam technique and revision checklist

- Always distinguish "efficiency" from "effectiveness" precisely with an example — a very commonly and specifically tested definition pair.
- Functions of management: know all five by name, and be ready to explain why they're continuous/overlapping, not sequential.
- Organisational structure "distinguish" questions: use consistent criteria (basis of organisation, suitability) on both sides.
- Motivation theory questions: know each theory's specific structure (Maslow's five levels; Herzberg's two factor types; McGregor's X/Y assumptions) precisely.
- Span of control questions: always show the division calculation explicitly, then explain the tall/flat structure trade-off in words.

Quick revision — one line per topic:

1. Management: working through people/resources to achieve goals efficiently and effectively.
2. Functions: planning, organising, staffing, directing, controlling — continuous and overlapping.
3. Levels: top (strategy), middle (departmental plans), lower (direct supervision).
4. Structures: functional (by function), divisional (by product/market), matrix (combined, more complex).
5. Maslow: physiological → safety → social → esteem → self-actualisation.
6. Herzberg: hygiene factors (prevent dissatisfaction) vs motivators (drive motivation).
7. Leadership: autocratic (unilateral), democratic (participative), laissez-faire (autonomous).
8. Span of control: narrow = tall structure/closer supervision; wide = flat structure/more delegation.

End of study notes. This document is intended as original exam-preparation material and should be used alongside the current official KASNEB syllabus and examiner's reports for the paper.